

DOCUMENT 94 · OBLIGATION MATRIX AND LAYERED READING

Obligation matrix and layered reading

What is always mandatory, what depends on the company or the initiative, what can be grouped and what is never omitted

Fernando García Varela Version 0.1 (working draft) 19-09-2026 Draft for review

3

reading layers

5

obligation levels

0

gates that can be omitted

15

triggers that activate modules

IN THIS DOCUMENT

01	Purpose and scope	07	Templates
02	How to read the matrix	08	Tools
03	What is never omitted	09	Where to start, by profile
04	Triggers	10	Associated tools and templates
05	Phases and gates: what can be grouped and what cannot	11	Related documents
06	Documents	12	Version control

Legal notice and disclaimer. SEVEN-G is a reference methodological framework provided "as is" and for information purposes only. It does not constitute legal, regulatory, financial or professional advice, nor does it guarantee compliance with any law or standard. References to general regulation (such as the EU AI Act, the GDPR, DORA or NIS2), to technical standards and to regulation specific to each sector or jurisdiction may be incomplete, may not apply to a particular case or may become out of date as a result of regulatory changes, interpretations or supervisory positions after their consultation date. **Each organisation that uses SEVEN-G is solely responsible for identifying the regulation that applies to it, verifying that it is current and certifying its own regulatory compliance**, with the appropriate qualified advice. The author accepts no liability for any use made of this content or for any decisions taken on the basis of it. The data, figures, companies and cases in the examples are fictitious or illustrative.

THE ESSENTIALS

Recommended

Guidance document so that the whole library does not have to be read. It says what is mandatory in every company, what is added only with Enterprise intensity or scope, which modules are activated by a trigger and what is guidance or reference. Underlying rule: no phase or gate is omitted; in Lite they are grouped and simplified. It creates no rules: if it differs from documents 01, 21 or 90, those prevail.

Obligation matrix and layered reading (document 94)

01

Purpose and scope

Not all companies have the same capacity for effort or the same risk exposure. SEVEN-G handles this with **a single library that is read in layers**, not with several versions of each document: that way there

are no parallel texts that could contradict each other, and a company that grows does not have to change framework.

This document brings together in one place what other documents establish about proportionality:

- the **intensity** of each initiative, Lite or Enterprise (document 01, section 9);
- the company's **implementation scope**, Lite or Enterprise, and its minimum path (document 90, section 2);
- the **obligation of each gate criterion** and its application in Lite (document 21, section 2);
- the **scopes** that apply only to certain technologies: generative AI, agents and third parties (document 21, section 2.3).

It creates no new rules. If a row in this document differs from its source document, **the source document prevails**.

Why it matters. A framework that seems to demand everything ends up being applied in full to what does not need it, or not being applied at all. Knowing what is non-negotiable and what is proportionate makes it possible to start small without lowering what protects the company.

02

How to read the matrix

2.1 Three reading layers

Layer	What it contains	For whom
1 • Essential	What every company applies, whatever its size: the <i>Always</i> level items. Each document summarises it in its "The essentials" box, after the legal notice.	Every company, from day one.
2 • Conditional	Modules that are activated when a trigger occurs (section 4): <i>Enterprise</i> and <i>Conditional</i> levels.	The company or initiative that meets the trigger.
3 • Complete	Working guides, catalogues, examples and reference material: <i>Recommended</i> and <i>Reference</i> levels.	Whoever needs to go deeper into a topic.

A medium-sized company with Lite initiatives works in layer 1 and enters layer 2 only where its initiatives take it. A regulated group with Enterprise scope applies layers 1 and 2 almost in full. Layer 3 is available to everyone.

2.2 Five obligation levels

Level	Meaning	Vocabulary of 01
Always	Mandatory in every company and every initiative, Lite or Enterprise. In Lite it may be simplified; not omitted.	must
Enterprise	Mandatory in full when the initiative has Enterprise intensity or the company has Enterprise scope. In Lite there is a reduced version, which is indicated.	must, under that condition
Conditional	Mandatory only when its trigger occurs. Without a trigger, it does not apply and is recorded as such.	must, under that condition
Recommended	Working guide or good practice. It may be omitted with justification. The mandatory content it develops is already covered in another document or in a template.	should
Reference	Reference material: glossary, catalogues, examples, explanations.	may

A document's level indicates **when what it regulates has to be applied**, not that it must be read in full: its "The essentials" box says which part is the minimum.

03

What is never omitted

These twelve rules hold for any company, with any scope and in any initiative. They are what distinguishes applying SEVEN-G from using some of its templates.

#	Rule	Source
1	Complete inventory of AI systems —own, third-party, corporate use and unauthorised— with an owner.	document 32; document 90, section 2.4
2	Every initiative is registered before consuming budget, with its dates per phase, decisions, criteria and closing reason.	document 01, section 6.11; document 03
3	Intensity is determined for each initiative in phase 0 and reviewed at G3 and at each R6. One Enterprise criterion is enough.	document 01, section 9

#	Rule	Source
4	No phase or gate is skipped. In Lite they may be grouped into one session; each gate keeps its criteria and its record.	document 21, section 3.4
5	G3 is always decided separately: it is the main stop gate.	document 01, section 6.1; document 90, section 2.4
6	Segregation of duties: whoever builds neither verifies nor decides their own work, and risk clearance is independent of the team.	document 01, section 8; document 30
7	Dual validation and evidence prior to the decision: without verified evidence there is no decision.	document 21, sections 3 and 4
8	The "Yes ♦" criteria (security, legal compliance, human oversight) are never accepted as a condition.	document 21, section 2.2
9	Value hypothesis with baseline and stop criteria before investing in feasibility, and measurement rules in all figures.	document 01, section 6; document 40
10	Regulatory classification and risk register before design; a Critical residual risk without board approval blocks G3 and G5.	document 32; document 33
11	Tested rollback plan and current continuity review for everything in production.	document 52
12	The board approves the direction and the risk appetite (C2), receives AI information at least quarterly and approves Transform bets.	document 01, section 5; document 13

04

Triggers

A trigger is a verifiable circumstance of the company or the initiative that activates a module. The first eight are the Enterprise criteria of 01 §9.2: any of them gives the initiative Enterprise intensity.

#	Trigger	What it activates
1	High-risk system under the applicable regulation	Enterprise intensity · document 34 · impact assessments (P11, P47, P48) · data requirements of document 51
2	Decisions about people	Enterprise intensity · document 50 · enhanced human oversight (P17) · P46 when the law requires information
3	Direct exposure to customers or external people	Enterprise intensity · transparency notices (P49) · adversarial testing (P53)

#	Trigger	What it activates
4	Agents with autonomy A2 or A3 with an effect on third parties, money, personal data or production	Enterprise intensity · document 35 · LV-AG checklist · full P18 · P54
5	Specially protected data	Enterprise intensity · P47 · document 51
6	Critical function or one subject to operational resilience	Enterprise intensity · document 34 (DORA, NIS2) · enhanced continuity in document 52
7	Transform ambition level	Enterprise intensity · board approval at G2 and, if scaled, at G7
8	Investment above the threshold approved in C2	Enterprise intensity
9	Generative AI (criteria tagged GEN)	GEN criteria of document 21 · document 35 · consumption budget (P63)
10	Agents with autonomy A1 (criteria tagged AG)	AG criteria of document 21 · minimum controls per autonomy level of document 35
11	An AI supplier is involved (criteria tagged TER), including AI embedded in contracted software	document 36 · P14 · P55, P56 and P57 depending on level N1 to N3
12	Personal data is processed	document 34 (GDPR) · P47 when the processing requires it · document 51
13	The initiative changes people's work or releases capacity	document 50 · full document 23 · P46
14	The solution is built with AI-generated code	document 53 · P66
15	The company meets an Enterprise scope criterion (90 §2.2)	AI Committee with its own session · auditor at every Enterprise gate · full document 38 · P42 · independent maturity assessment every two years

An isolated Transform bet makes that initiative Enterprise, but **does not change the company's scope** (document 90, section 2.2).

Phases and gates: what can be grouped and what cannot

Phase and gate	Can it be omitted?	In Lite intensity	In Enterprise intensity
0 • Context and constraints → G0	No	G0, G1 and G2 may be resolved in a single session ; each gate keeps its list of criteria and its section in P29. Templates without the (<i>Enterprise</i>) fields. The AI Office verifies and the sponsor decides.	Each gate separately, full templates, AI Auditor at all of them, the AI Committee decides. In Transform, the board approves at G2.
1 • Opportunity discovery → G1	No	↑	↑
2 • Value hypothesis → G2	No	↑	↑
3 • Feasibility and risk → G3	No. Always separately	The sponsor decides with risk clearance.	The AI Committee decides with verification by the auditor.
4 • Solution design → G4	No	G4 and G5 may be resolved in a single session , with risk clearance at both.	Separately.
5 • Delivery and validation → G5	No	Go-live with risk clearance.	Multi-level sign-off with veto power.
6 • Operation → R6	No	Six-monthly continuity review.	Quarterly review.
7 • Evolution or retirement → G7	No. It is convened when scaling or retirement is proposed, or when R6 brings it forward	The sponsor decides.	The AI Committee decides; the board, if a Transform bet is scaled.

Three situations that look like skips and are not:

- **Systems that were already in production** before the framework was implemented. They do not go back through the phases: they are placed in the phase supported by their real evidence and go through a review equivalent to G7, with documentation identified as regularisation (document 14, section 11; document 90, section 5).

- **Corporate use of general-purpose AI tools.** This is not an initiative with phases: it is governed through the acceptable use policy, the catalogue of authorised tools and the inventory (document 31, section 5).
- **An opportunity that arrives already well defined.** Phases 1 and 2 may be brief, but their evidence—alternatives without AI, falsifiable hypothesis, baseline, stop criteria—remains what makes it possible to stop later on.

06

Documents

Each document shows this same level in its "The essentials" box, with the minimum part that must be applied or the trigger that activates it.

No.	Document	Level	For whom
00	What SEVEN-G is and how it helps companies	Always	Everyone
01	SEVEN-G foundational methodology	Always	Management, AI Office, risk, audit
02	SEVEN-G glossary and conventions	Reference	Everyone
03	SEVEN-G tools and initiative register	Always	AI Office
04	Where SEVEN-G comes from, how it differs and why it is open	Reference	Everyone
10	Sphere map and ambition levels	Always	Management, AI Office, business
11	Maturity model	Always	AI Office, audit
12	Transformation index	Always	Board, management, AI Office
13	AI thesis, ambition and risk appetite	Always	Board, senior management
14	Portfolio management	Always	AI Committee, AI Office
20	Phase manuals	Recommended	Initiative teams
21	Gate and audit criteria	Always	AI Office, verifiers, decision-makers
22	Checklists by gate	Recommended	Verifiers, initiative teams
23	Adoption and change in the initiative	Recommended	Product owners, people function

No.	Document	Level	For whom
30	Governance model	Always	Management, board secretariat, AI Office
31	Corporate AI policy and acceptable use policy	Always	Management, compliance, people function
32	AI system inventory and regulatory classification	Always	AI Office, risk, compliance
33	AI risk methodology	Always	Risk owners
34	Regulatory mapping	Conditional	Compliance, legal counsel
35	AI and agent security	Conditional	Security, technical owners
36	AI third parties and suppliers	Conditional	Procurement, risk, legal counsel
37	Nonconformities, AI incidents and remediation	Always	Risk, compliance, operations
38	AI audit framework	Enterprise	Internal audit, AI auditors
40	Value measurement rules	Always	Management control, AI Office, business
41	Indicator catalogue	Reference	AI Office, management control
42	AI costs and allocation per use case	Recommended	Management control, technology
43	Benefits realisation	Recommended	Benefit owners, management control
50	People and organisation	Conditional	People function, labour relations
51	Data and knowledge for AI	Conditional	Data, data protection
52	AI operations manual	Always	Operations owners
53	Building solutions with AI	Conditional	Technical owners
54	How a company organises itself for AI	Reference	Board, senior management, AI Office
60	Board pack	Always	Board secretariat, AI Office
61	Board conversation guide	Recommended	Directors, management
62	Recommendations and decisions register	Always	Board secretariat, AI Office
90	SEVEN-G implementation guide	Always	Sponsor, implementation lead

No.	Document	Level	For whom
91	Guide for consultants and support models	Conditional	Consultants, procurement
92	Application cases	Reference	Everyone
93	Licence, use by third parties and citation	Conditional	Legal counsel, consultants
94	Obligation matrix and layered reading	Recommended	Everyone
95	Where your data is and how to install SEVEN-G on your own server	Conditional	AI Office, IT and security, consultants and partners

The fact that a document is *Always* does not mean it must be read in full: nineteen documents have that level, but the initial reading for a company with Lite scope comes down to documents 00 and 01, the implementation guide, the adaptation of the governance model to small organisations and the Lite column of the gate criteria (document 90, section 2.4). The rest is opened when its moment in the cycle arrives.

07

Templates

7.1 Lifecycle evidence (P01–P31)

No mandatory evidence is omitted in Lite: it is simplified. Each template marks with (*Enterprise*) the fields that a Lite initiative may leave blank.

Templates	Level	Note
P01, P02, P03, P04, P05 (phase 0)	Always	P04 is reviewed at G3 and at each R6.
P06, P07 (phase 1) · P08, P09 (phase 2)	Always	—
P10, P11, P12, P13 (phase 3)	Always	In P11 the classification is always mandatory; impact assessments, only when the classification requires them.
P14 (phase 3)	Conditional	Trigger 11: an AI supplier is involved.
P15, P16, P17, P18, P19, P20 (phase 4)	Always	In P18, the agents block applies only with triggers 4 or 10.

Templates	Level	Note
P21, P22, P23 (phase 5)	Always	In P23, multi-level sign-off with veto is Enterprise; in Lite, risk clearance.
P24, P25, P26, P27, P28 (phase 6)	Always	From entry into production.
P29 (all gates) · P31 (use case sheet)	Always	—
P30 (phase 7)	Always	When G7 is convened.

7.2 Company, board, compliance, third parties, audit and implementation (P32–P71)

Templates	Level	Trigger or note
P32, P33, P34, P35, P36, P37 (implementation and corporate cycle)	Always	P37 at each annual review.
P38 (rules of procedure or mandate of the bodies)	Always	In Lite scope, extended mandate of the existing bodies.
P39 (agenda and minutes) · P44 (usage survey) · P68 (board session notes)	Recommended	The company may use its own formats.
P40 (exceptions)	Conditional	When an exception is requested.
P41 (independence and conflicts of interest)	Conditional	Verifiers and auditors of Enterprise initiatives, and external support.
P42 (quarterly second-line report)	Enterprise	Trigger 15. In Lite scope, its content goes into the AI item of the management committee.
P43 (authorised tools) · P45 (literacy and training)	Always	—
P46 (information to workers)	Conditional	Triggers 2 or 13, when the law requires information or consultation.
P47 (DPIA) · P48 (fundamental rights) · P49 (transparency)	Conditional	Triggers 1, 3, 5 or 12, as required by the regulation.
P50 (nonconformity register)	Always	—
P51 (notifications) · P52 (root cause)	Conditional	Notifiable incident; major or critical nonconformity, or S1 or S2 incident.

Templates	Level	Trigger or note
P53 (adversarial testing) · P54 (non-human identities)	Conditional	Triggers 3, 4, 9 or 10.
P55, P56, P57 (suppliers)	Conditional	Trigger 11, with the detail required by level N1 to N3.
P58, P59 (audit plan and working papers)	Enterprise	Trigger 15.
P60 (audit report)	Always	In Lite scope, report of the six-monthly sample review.
P61 (declaration of application)	Conditional	When the company declares that it applies SEVEN-G.
P62 (benefits realisation plan) · P65 (R6 pack)	Always	P62 from G3; P65 from entry into production.
P63 (consumption budget) · P64 (datasets and sources) · P66 (SPAD annexes)	Conditional	Trigger 9 · own data or knowledge · trigger 14.
P67 (quarterly board pack) · P69 (register of board decisions)	Always	Aggregated in Lite scope.
P70, P71 (consultancy)	Conditional	External support.

08

Tools

No tool is mandatory as an application: what is mandatory is the register or the calculation it contains. A company may keep it in a spreadsheet with the data model of document 03.

Tool	Level of what it contains	Note
T01 · Initiative register (with T02 inventory, T03 gates, T04 intensity, T05 ambition, T06 risks and T18 board)	Always	It is the central piece: the other tools read its data.
T14 · Transformation index · T15 · Maturity diagnosis	Always	At C1 and at each C5.
T17 · Board dashboard	Always	Aggregated in Lite scope; per initiative for Enterprise ones.

Tool	Level of what it contains	Note
T11 · Value calculator (with T13 costs)	Recommended	The formulas of document 40 are mandatory; the calculator is an aid.
Rest of the catalogue	According to its procedure	They are applied with the template or document indicated in the catalogue of document 03.

09

Where to start, by profile

Profile	Minimum reading	Afterwards
Board director	document 00 (sections 1 to 6) · document 61	document 12 · document 60 · example board dashboard (T17)
Senior management and AI Committee	document 00 · document 01 · document 90 (section 2) · this document	document 13 · document 14 · document 40
AI lead or AI Office	All of the above · document 03 · document 21 · document 30 (section 11 in Lite)	The <i>AI/ways</i> level documents as the 90-day plan progresses
Risk, compliance and audit	document 01 (sections 7 to 12) · document 21 · document 32 · document 33 · document 37	document 34 · document 35 · document 36 · document 38, depending on the triggers
Initiative team	document 01 (section 6) · the relevant phase of document 20 · the templates of that phase	document 22 · document 40
Consultant	document 00 · document 01 · document 04 · document 91 · document 93	document 90 · document 92

The SEVEN-G course follows these same paths with short modules, exercises on the example data and self-check questions.

Associated tools and templates

Code	Name	Relationship
P04	Intensity determination	Records which Enterprise criteria each initiative meets.
T04	Intensity determination (T01 module)	Applies the criteria of 01 §9.2 when the initiative is registered.
T03	<i>Gate</i> manager (T01 module)	Shows, for each gate, the criteria that apply according to the initiative's intensity and tags.
P32	Implementation mandate	Sets the company's implementation scope.

Related documents

Document	Relationship
01 · Foundational methodology	Normative vocabulary (section 1.4), gates (section 7) and Lite and Enterprise intensity (section 9).
21 · Gate and audit criteria	Obligation of each criterion, Lite and Enterprise column, scope tags and grouped gates.
30 · Governance model	Adaptation to small organisations (section 11).
41 · Indicator catalogue	Minimum set of indicators for Lite (section 19).
52 · AI operations manual	Lite and Enterprise operation (section 14).
90 · Implementation guide	Implementation scope, selection criteria and minimum path in Lite scope (section 2).
SEVEN-G course	Learning paths by profile.

Version control

Version	Date	Changes
0.1	19-09-2026	First version. Three reading layers, five obligation levels, twelve rules that are never omitted, fifteen triggers, what can be grouped in phases and gates, level of each document, template and tool, and minimum reading by profile.

External sources cited

Links to the official or primary source, checked before publication. Always verify the version in force on the date of use.

Directive (EU) 2022/2555 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 14 December 2022 on measures for a high common level of cybersecurity across the Union (NIS 2 Directive) · <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/dir/2022/2555/oj/eng> · Parlamento Europeo y Consejo de la UE · 14-12-2022

Regulation (EU) 2016/679 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 27 April 2016 on the protection of natural persons with regard to the processing of personal data and on the free movement of such data, and repealing Directive 95/46/EC (General Data Protection Regulation) · <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2016/679/oj/eng> · Parlamento Europeo y Consejo de la UE · 27-04-2016

Regulation (EU) 2022/2554 of the European Parliament and of the Council of 14 December 2022 on digital operational resilience for the financial sector (DORA) · <https://eur-lex.europa.eu/eli/reg/2022/2554/oj/eng> · Parlamento Europeo y Consejo de la UE · 14-12-2022